The Noble Parṇaśabarī Sūtra

Āryaparṇaśabarīsūtra · Toh 994 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་པར་ཎ་ཤ་བ་རའི་མདོ།

The Noble Parṇaśabarī Sūtra, known in Sanskrit as the Āryaparṇaśabarīsūtra and in Tibetan as Phagpa Parnashawari Do, is a short protective text centered on Parṇaśabarī, a goddess traditionally associated with warding off epidemics and other dangers. It opens with homage to the Three Jewels, to the buddha Amitābha, and to the bodhisattvas Avalokiteśvara and Mahāsthāmaprāpta. It then gives an extended incantation in Sanskrit that invokes Parṇaśabarī and asks for protection, safeguarding, and care for the reciter and all beings against fears, plagues, calamities, and harmful influences. It is Toh 994 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the incantations and spells valued for their protective power.

The Noble Parṇaśabarī Sūtra

Homage to the Three Jewels.
Homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Amitābha.
Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara.
Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being Mahāsthāmaprāpta.

bāmanetraṃ namasyamitvanamasyāmi bāmane bhagabate biśāci parṇṇaśabari biśāci pāśaparśudhāriṇī yāni kānicida bhayānyātādyaṃteyaḥ kācidamārayo yaḥ kācid mahāmārayo ye kecida ubadṇabāḥ ye kecid upāyāsā ye kecid abhyādmikā bhayā ye kecida upasargga upasargga saṃbaddhabā uhbadyante sarbāni tāni sarbasta sarbitabālatā ebotbadyante nabaṇḍitataḥ tadanenastyenastyapacanenastyapābakena tadyathā oṃ jaḥ jāḥ jaḥ jāḥ ebhiṣaḥ paṇḍita adhiṣṣitaira mantrapadaira mama sarbasatvānānaca rakṣaṃ kuru paritrāṇaṃ kuru parigrahaṃ kuru paripālanaṃ kuru śāntiṃ kuru svastāyanaṃ kuru daṇṇaparihāraṃ kuru śastāparihāraṃ kuru yābad biṣadhuṣaṇaṃ kuru agniparihāraṃ kuru udakaparihāraṃ kuru kakhordacchedanaṃ kuru sīmābandhaṃ kuru dharaṇīpandhaṃ kuru tadyathā amite amite amitoddhabe amitasaṃbhabe āśvaste āśvastāṃge māmara māmara māsara māsara śambraśam upasama sarbabyadhīnupasma sarba akālamṛtyunupasama sarba nakṣatragrahadoṣṇanupasama sarba daṃṣṭīṇāṃ caubasama bhagapati parṇṇaśabari tyuṃna tyuṃna bityuṃna bityuṃna tuna tuna tumule svāhā

oṃ gauri gandharī caurī caṇḍali mātaṃgi bukkāsi svāhā

namaḥ sarbaśabarāṇāṃ mahāśabarāṇāṃ bhagabati biśāci barṇṇaśabari svāhā

oṃ biśāci barṇṇaśabari hrīḥ h hūṃ phaṭ piśāci svāhā

oṃ aṃkure maṃkure kurare parṇṇaśabari svāhā

For cattle disease, make a thread, recite the mantra over it one hundred and eight times, and tie one hundred and eight knots in it. Together with a vessel on which the heart mantra has been written, perform the recitation properly. After that, wash the sick one, or the horses, cattle and other animals, with water; wash the bull of the herd as well, and if the thread is tied on its head, the disease will be pacified.

Likewise, when harm has befallen buffaloes, goats and sheep, the mantra should be written in their pen. Fill a vase with clean water, charge it with the mantra one hundred and eight times, and wash them with it; the harm will then be pacified.

In the early morning, go to the cattle pen and make a torma of scents and flowers. Fill a new, unused vase with water and charge it with the mantra one hundred and eight times. At the door of the cattle pen erect a gateway. For that gateway, write the vidyā with gorocanā on the leaves of a plantain tree and hang them at the top of the gateway. Then all the livestock that have gone out to graze are to be brought in through the door of the gateway.

Furthermore, fill four vases with water and charge them with the mantra one hundred and eight times; if four people sprinkle the water, the livestock will become free of disease. If this is likewise done for seven days, all diseases will be pacified.

For disease among people and disease among livestock, write the mantra on birch bark, make offerings to it, and fasten it to the top of a banner.

For fear of tigers, recite the mantra over a bell and ring it.

For fear of sea monsters, if one charges arrows and bricks with the mantra, then snakes, rats, scorpions and the like will also have their mouths bound.

At the battlefront, charge ash with the mantra; if one smears it on the crown of the head and on the neck, it turns back weapons.

Having recited the mantra over a thread one hundred and eight times, tie it to the sick person's bed. Bathe him with a vase charged with the mantra one hundred and eight times. Having recited over it with the hand, tie it on his body. Then he will become well.

If one goes around the land reciting the mantra over bells, drums and conches, all obstructors will scatter and harm too will be pacified.

If one places the vidyā as a mark on the forehead of a brave warrior and hands him weapons, enemies or battle will be quelled.

The Noble Parṇaśabarī Sūtra is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The word rendered simply "water" in the first cattle rite is written glos chu, which is not a known compound; the qualifier of the water is left untranslated. "Gone out to graze" reads gzas as an evident slip for gzan, "to graze." The phrase sku dpal in "having recited over it with the hand, tie it on his body" is obscure, and the rendering is tentative. The "water tree" (chu shing) is taken as the plantain or banana tree, its usual sense.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.